

George Jerry Francis

Product Manager | Solution Architect | Customer Success

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Professional Summary

Dynamic telecommunications leader with 20+ years of industry expertise and 6 years in strategic Product Management, delivering measurable business impact across optical networks and managed services. Architected award-winning optical network management innovations, including ESG solutions that captured the 2024 Network Infrastructure Quality Award and expanded market presence throughout Europe and Asia-Pacific. Consistently delivered value by pioneering AI/ML monetization strategies, zero-touch automation frameworks, and network slicing technologies that created new recurring revenue opportunities. Demonstrated exceptional cross-functional leadership—from securing multimillion-dollar contracts through compelling pre-sales initiatives to establishing Centers of Excellence that accelerated growth in competitive markets. Combines deep technical expertise across optical systems, NMS frameworks, and SDN protocols with strategic business acumen to drive organizational success and industry advancement.

Skills

- Product/Program Management: Strategy, Roadmap Development, Positioning, Marketing, Proof Of Concept
- Business Analysis: Requirements Gathering, Discovery, Customer Engagement, Market Analysis
- Network Technologies: Optical (DWDM, OTN, L2, SONET), Ethernet, 5G Foundational, SNMP, TL1, CLI, Netconf, TMF814, Infiniband, Software Defined Networking
- Network Management: FCAPS, EMS/NMS, OSS Systems, Planning & Optimization, Health & Analytics
- Tools & Technologies: Agile, Scrum, Lean, Six Sigma, Waterfall, JIRA, Risk Management, Java, C, C++, REST, UML, Data Modeling, AWS Cloud and AI Foundational
- Innovation: AI/ML use cases, Sustainability (ESG) Initiatives, API Development, Workflow Automation, Architecture refactoring

Work Experience

Network Automation Product Line Manager & Solution Architect

Nokia of America Corporation | January 2019 - December 2024 | USA

- Generated \$200M in revenue by leading cross-functional pre-sales initiatives, delivering compelling demos and presentations that increased North American market share from a major US telecom

customer

- Successfully secured RFP win by architecting a zero-touch optical provisioning solution with seamless API integrations between service enablement, planning, network management and network optimization tools
- Expanded market presence in Europe and Asia-Pacific by developing and implementing a comprehensive ESG strategy centered on network energy efficiency innovations
- Won the prestigious 2024 Network Infrastructure Quality Award by optimizing ESG features through network-level automation that significantly increased customer centricity & satisfaction
- Created new revenue streams by strategically positioning AI/ML capabilities across the product portfolio, enabling advanced network planning, root cause analysis, proactive maintenance, digital twins and energy optimization
- Elevated product visibility as speaker at industry events, showcasing product innovations and establishing thought leadership in the networking space
- Secured executive buy-in for ESG sustainability initiatives by presenting a compelling business case that resulted in company-wide portfolio adoption
- Drove business growth by expanding product management coverage across North & South American markets, implementing metrics-driven regional reporting and accountability
- Ensured timely delivery of strategic product features across 12 software releases by establishing effective cross-functional coordination and milestone tracking
- Developed market-validated MVP requirements through structured customer discovery, incorporating improved usability standards, enhanced UX principles, and streamlined API specifications
- Accelerated product adoption by creating comprehensive marketing materials, training content, and user documentation that improved customer onboarding efficiency

NMS Systems Engineer

Alcatel Lucent (Nokia) | July 2014 - December 2018 | India

- Generated new revenue stream for Network as a Service (NaaS) management of tenant services through publication of an influential white paper on Network Slicing for Optical Networks
- Enhanced product capabilities by delivering critical technical specifications for Optical NMS features including Lightpath Cumulative OSNR, Alien wave support, LLDP based topology discovery and GMPLS control plane auto-discovery
- Modernized network infrastructure by evaluating and implementing next-generation protocols (gRPC, Netconf, RestConf) and defining Yang models for network synchronization and data streaming
- Accelerated innovation cycles through collaborative leadership of use case discovery and prototype development with product management and R&D teams
- Delivered feature enhancements across 10 software releases by conducting thorough system requirement analysis and definition
- Facilitated successful product introductions by establishing testbed environments and conducting compelling feature demonstrations

- Improved Quality Assurance KPIs by developing practical customer use cases and deployment scenarios that aligned with real-world applications
- Broadened technical impact by expanding domain expertise from network management to comprehensive network design and planning
- Contributed to organizational innovation strategy through multiple idea submissions to Nokia Global Innovation Mall

Senior Product Architect

Tech Mahindra | June 2012 - June 2014 | India & Norway

- Generated \$7M in new revenue by crafting and successfully converting a compelling OSS Development RFP proposal into a signed contract
- Expanded market reach by establishing and managing the NMS Framework Center of Excellence program, creating new business opportunities and technical capabilities
- Drove innovation adoption by designing and validating OF-CONFIG & OpenFlow SDN use cases that addressed emerging customer needs and technological requirements
- Elevated executive visibility through structured project planning, metrics tracking, and strategic status reporting that ensured alignment with organizational objectives
- Improved team performance by implementing targeted mentorship and performance management strategies that enhanced engineering capabilities and delivery outcomes

Solution Architect

Wipro Technologies | February 2012 - June 2012 | India & Ireland

- Reduced operational costs by successfully launching offshore projects for WCDMA Radio Access Network Configuration management, optimizing resource allocation
- Demonstrated exceptional adaptability by rapidly acquiring domain expertise in 3G/UMTS architecture and OSS models, enabling quick contribution to critical projects
- Exceeded delivery expectations by completing the first user story within a compressed 2-week timeline, establishing momentum for subsequent development phases

Software Architect

Wipro Technologies | December 2008 - January 2012 | India & Canada

- Improved operational efficiency by 50% through design and optimization of the NDS data stitching algorithm, significantly reducing network alignment time
- Secured stakeholder buy-in for G.805 based transport data model refactoring, enabling architectural improvements that enhanced system performance

Project Manager

Wipro Technologies | May 2006 - November 2008 | India & USA

- Built operational capability by establishing a fully-staffed Offshore Delivery Center with comprehensive project execution framework and governance
- Ensured client satisfaction by serving as the primary point of contact for project management and issue resolution, providing responsive escalation management

Software Development Team Leader / Software Developer

Wipro Technologies | August 1999 - April 2006 | India & Canada

- Reduced testing costs by creating and deploying the Overhead Manipulator tool for SONET/SDH control, streamlining quality assurance processes
- Delivered product excellence by coding, testing, and implementing multiple optical network products and features that met or exceeded customer requirements
- Enhanced support capabilities by conducting comprehensive product troubleshooting training and serving in global product support teams, improving resolution times

Education

Bachelor of Engineering(B.E.) in Computer Science - Mumbai University, India(1999)

Awards and Certifications

- NVIDIA Infiniband Essentials (2025)
- AWS Educate: Machine Learning Foundations, Generative AI and Serverless (2025)
- LinkedIn Courses: 5G Advanced & Introduction to 5G (2025)
- LinkedIn Courses: AWS Cloud Concepts, AWS Cloud Technology & Services, AWS Cloud Billing, Pricing & Services (2024)
- LinkedIn Courses: What is Generative AI & Introduction to Prompt Engineering (2024)
- Network Infrastructure Quality Award (2024)
- Product Management Expert Development Course (2018)
- AT&T Network API Innovation Contest Winner
- Tech Mahindra Young CEO Program Finalist